



Arts and Culture Microgrant (ACM) 2026 Application

A thriving arts and culture scene makes Calgary a more livable city by strengthening the local economy, enriching cultural diversity, supporting well-being and creating social connections for all individuals.

The Arts and Culture Microgrant supports **new arts and culture initiatives and programming** led by eligible community organizations that celebrate arts and culture and help activate culturally vibrant communities and districts in Calgary. The microgrant also supports recurring initiatives that introduce at least one new and significant programming element.

Summary of the Guidelines (read the full guidelines before submitting your application)

5 Core Elements

Initiatives should include the **five core elements** (see the guidelines for more information about each):

- New and Creative
- Cultural Learning & Art Appreciation
- Collaboration and Partnerships
- Accessibility and Participation
- Equity, Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging

The Arts and Culture Microgrant supports initiatives that promote respect and dignity of all people regardless of race, culture, national or ethnic origin, religion, education, age, ability, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, or socio-economic status. **We do not support:** political initiatives, rallies, protests, proselytizing, fundraising, annual general meetings, potlucks, banquets, or events that take place in private residences.

Funding Tiers

The Arts and Culture Microgrant will offer \$1 million in funding, divided between two tiers of funding, over 3 intake periods. Applicants should apply for the tier that aligns with their initiative timeline and budget.

- Tier 1
 - Up to \$5,000 per application
 - The grant will cover up to 100% of eligible expenses
 - Apply a minimum of 30 days before your initiative begins
 - Activities must be completed in 2026
 - Limit of 1 grant per organization, per year
- Tier 2
 - Up to \$30,000 per application
 - Matching grant that covers up to 50% of project expenses
 - **Intake 1: Apply by March 4** for activities beginning between Jun 1 and Nov 30, 2026
 - **Intake 2: Apply by September 2** for activities beginning between Dec 1, 2026 and May 31, 2027
 - Limit of 1 grant per initiative. Organizations may submit applications for multiple initiatives.

Eligibility Requirements

Applications must meet all eligibility requirements to be considered for funding.

Eligible Organizations MUST:

- Be one of the following:
 - Registered non-profit (can be registered provincially or federally)
 - Registered charity
 - Community Association ([click here for more information](#))
 - Business Improvement Area ([click here for more information](#))
- Be in good standing with the City of Calgary, with no outstanding reports or payments
- Not receive funding via [Festival and Events Subsidy Program \(FESP\)](#), Festival and Events Subsidy Program Operations Assistance Fund (FESP-OAF), or [Downtown in Motion](#) for the same initiative.
- Play an active role in the initiative (cannot apply on behalf of another organization without playing an active role in the project)

Eligible Initiatives MUST:

- Incorporate all **five core elements** outlined on page 1 of the guidelines
- Start and end within the activity window specified for the tier and intake you're applying for.
- Occur within the geographic boundaries of the city of Calgary
- Provide meaningful benefit to the Calgary community

Eligible Applications MUST:

- Include responses to every question in the application form
- Be submitted before 11:59 p.m. MT on the application deadline day
- Be signed by the grant writer

Eligible (and ineligible) Expenses:

Funding may be applied to direct costs that support the delivery of your initiative and does not extend to ongoing operational or capital costs. See the guidelines for a list of eligible and ineligible expenses.

SECTION A – Applicant Information			
Organization Information			
Name of Organization	SAHAN HERITAGE FOUNDATION		
Type of Organization	Not for Profit (Provincial)	NFP/Charity Registration #	
Mailing Address	66 Redstone Road Ne		
City, Province	Calgary, AB	Postal Code	T3N 0M3
Project Contact		Signing Authority	
Name	Abdikhadar Obsiye	Name	Abdikhadar Obsiye
Position	Vice President	Position	Vice President
Email	sahanheritage@gmail.com	Email	sahanheritage@gmail.com
Phone Number	5875002073	Phone Number	5875002073
Application Details			
Which tier of the Arts and Culture Microgrant are you applying for?			Tier 1
Has your organization received past Arts and Culture Microgrant funding?			☐ Yes ☒ No

SECTION B – About the Initiative			
Initiative Title	Las Geel Cultural Night, A Journey through Human Continuity		
Initiative Location(s) *provide address(es)	Amenida Hotel, Hall 1 (4206 Macleod Trail South)		
Initiative Start Date	6/27/26	Initiative End Date	
Is your initiative new?	New Initiative		

1. Provide an overview of your initiative *(ideal response length 300 – 500 words)*

- For new initiatives, describe the activities and programming elements.
- For pre-existing initiatives, describe both the existing initiative and the new programming elements.
- How does your new initiative or programming element bring innovation that's unique to Calgary or your organization?
- How does the new initiative or programming element show innovation and add value to the overall project?

Las Geel Cultural Night is an indoor exhibition and performance that brings the "Birth of Civilization" in the Horn of Africa to life, connecting that ancient history to our shared human experience here in Canada.

We are transforming Hall 1 of the hotel to look and feel like the Las Geel caves, giving 250 guests a visual walk through of 9,000-year-old rock art some of the very first creative works ever made by humans. The evening is centered on storytelling and connection. We've invited Elders from both the Horn of Africa diaspora and local Indigenous communities to speak about their oral histories.

They will be looking at the surprising links between ancient African rock art and Canadian Indigenous, showing us that even though our backgrounds are different, our ancestors used the same visual language to tell their stories. The night will also feature traditional folklore dancers and performances by Indigenous artists. To get the younger generation involved, we've put together a heritage trivia session for newcomer kids that blends Canadian geography with world history. It's a way for them to see themselves as part of a much older, global narrative. By using ancient archaeology to help with modern social integration and Indigenous reconciliation, we're trying something different to help people feel more connected to their new home and to each other.

2. How will your new initiative or programming elements benefit the arts and culture communities and the broader Calgary community? (ideal response length 150 – 250 words)

It benefit the community by showcasing the 9,000 year old Las Geel rock art, which is rarely highlighted in mainstream cultural events. By transforming a local hall into an immersive educational space, we are providing Calgary artists and residents with a rare look at the "Birth of Civilization" in the Horn of Africa.

The biggest benefit to our local arts community is the intentional bridge we are building between African diaspora artists and Indigenous creators. This collaboration allows both groups to share their traditional dances, oral histories, and visual symbols, fostering a deeper sense of mutual respect and shared heritage.

3. Who can access and participate in your initiative? (ideal response length 150 – 250 words)

- Are there any restrictions on participation?
- What barriers to participation (financial, physical, psychological, etc.) in your initiative exist?
- How will your organization ensure that all Calgarians feel invited and welcome to participate?

Las Geel Cultural Night is designed to be an open, inclusive event where all Calgarians are welcome to participate regardless of their background. There are no restrictions on who can attend we specifically want to see a mix of newcomer families, Indigenous community members, students, and art lovers. To ensure everyone feels invited, we are actively reaching out to local community centers, newcomer agencies, and Indigenous organizations to help spread the word through grassroots networks. To mitigate the financial barriers we are keeping the event free. We have also chosen an accessible venue it is a 5. min walking distance from 39 Avenue Station.

4a. Is there a fee to attend your initiative?

Free to attend

4b. What is your ticketing strategy?

- List all ticket types and prices
- How many tickets do you have for each type and price?
- Examples of ticket types are: free tickets (for audience members), pay what you can tickets, paid tickets, and industry/media/marketing comps

180 tickets for adults (This is the standard ticket) - Free (Pay what you can)

40 tickets for youth pass (they will participate in the trivia) - Free Pass

25 tickets reserved for other societies committees - Free pass

5 Tickets for Media (social media personnel included)

Currently we have 856\$ from previous event donated by the community (New year family gathering)

5a. How does your initiative demonstrate a commitment to equity, diversity, inclusion and belonging?
(ideal response length 200 – 300 words)

Equity-deserving groups are communities that experience significant collective barriers in participating in society. This could include historic, social, and environmental barriers based on age, ethnicity, disability, economic status, gender, nationality, race, sexual orientation, transgender status, etc.

We built our project on the principle that heritage is for everyone, not only for people who can buy a ticket. We are purposely dismantling the financial barriers that often leave equity deserving families watching cultural programs from the sidelines by going pay what you can policy.

We collected \$856 in donations during our last meeting, and with the fund we get, we can keep the event accessible.

Besides that, we give up the formal lecture format and go for a casual storytelling approach. This change not only turns the audience from passive listeners into active participators but also makes the participators more likely to engage with the content.

We want this invitation to go further than the usual circles, so we are doing a multilingual outreach. By placing ads in the different languages of our neighborhood, we are communicating that whatever your first language or background is, you have a seat at the table.

Finally, we are connecting the generational gap through our Youth Heritage Trivia.

5b. Does your initiative include any indigenous-led or indigenous-centered programming elements?

☒ Yes ☐ No

5c. If yes, describe the indigenous-led or indigenous-centered programming

Commitment to Truth and Reconciliation may take many forms, including but not limited to: strengthening understanding and awareness, building relationships and opportunities with indigenous artists and communities, and addressing one of more of the Truth and Reconciliation Commission's 91 calls to action.

Our programming is built on a very close collaboration with Indigenous Elder and artists in the local community to have their voices be the main part of the evening.

Bringing together the Elders of the two diasporas, the Horn of Africa and the local indigenous communities, through storytelling, we are able to reveal the strong ties that connect ancient African rock art with Canadian indigenous arts thus paving the way for a harmonious and understanding relationship as the two groups are henceforward being looked at as kindred spirits.

This also allows newcomers to Canada to gain a better understanding of the history and

6. How will your initiative foster collaboration with external partners (community-led organizations, businesses, and/or creative professionals)? (ideal response length: 150 – 250 words)

- Name your key collaborators
- Which of your key collaborators are new relationships and which are ongoing?
- What is your plan for building new and enhancing existing collaborations and partnerships?
- How will your collaborations strengthen Calgary's cultural community, create shared opportunities, and amplify the impact of your initiative?

Our key partners include the Elders from the Horn of Africa diaspora, the local Indigenous communities, and Horn of Africa folklore dancers. Our collaboration with local Indigenous Elders and artists is a fresh and very important link for this initiative.

To tell the story of the local Indigenous past, we intend to run children activities such as the giving away of free wristbands that has indigenous arts that will support this feeling of coming together. We reckon the community we are aiming at presently knows very little of the history of this land.

We are organizing these collaborations through community meetings and planning sessions where Elders from different communities will be able to sit down, listen to each other's oral histories and reflect on the similarities in their rock art. Besides that, the youth will be challenged with a trivia session to discover more about the history of Canada, in particular, the Indigenous peoples.

SECTION C - Implementation

7. How will you implement the initiative? (ideal response length: 200 – 350 words)

- What steps will you take?
- Provide a detailed timeline that includes key milestones and activities

The first step is formalizing our collaboration with local Indigenous Elders. In fact, we have contacted them and the team has welcomed the idea and given the first feedback, however, the date will be set once the funding is obtained. We have also talked with the hotel to get Hall 1. As we are regular customers, the hotel has kindly agreed to the booking, which is still waiting for final confirmation and payment.

We have designed the event flyers and intend to distribute them through the newcomer agencies and our social media platforms, as well as our WhatsApp channel with 80 active members. A focused team has been formed for the heritage trivia and is already taking the initiative. We are in the process of getting artist quotes to make the final decision on their bookings.

Our schedule starts off in February with the initial planning meetings with Horn of Africa Elders. At March, we will be done with booking the folklore dancers and performing artists. In April, the main focus will be on finalizing the exhibition layout and getting the materials for the cave transformation. On May we will distribute the invitations and start of social media campaigns.

8. How will you promote the initiative? *(ideal response length 150 – 300 words)*

- Describe your marketing plan
- What strategies will you use to reach and connect with your target audience?
- What steps will you take to bring awareness of your initiative beyond your regular audience?

One way that we are trying to widen our reach is through the members that are currently active in our WhatsApp group. There are 80 such members, and this is the group that we intend to use as the main source of word, of, mouth marketing within the Horn of Africa diaspora. This was our main strategy in our previous event. On new year we only posted in this group and 210 people showed up to the event, the word of mouth network is one strategy we depend on. This will not be the only channel as we need a diverse audience.

We have prepared the event flyers, and these will be our print mediums on pages as well as in local community centers to generate the buzz. We will also touch local Indigenous organizations and centers so that their community members are ensured a personal invitation to this cultural exchange.

9a. Do you plan to continue this initiative in future years?

☒ Yes ☐ No

9b. If yes, describe your plan for sustaining the initiative in the future. *(ideal response length 150 – 250 words)*

- Tell us about your plan
- Tell us how you intend to implement your plan

We intend to make this project a yearly summer event, putting it in the calendar during school breaks so that the young people can easily participate and the working volunteers can also be free.

Looking for ways to keep it sustainable in the long run, we are choosing community growth by collaborative work with a one, stop shop in Calgary that sells traditional costumes and provides materials.

By giving our orders to them first now, we are basically trying to guarantee future in-kind donations and sponsorship from our suppliers. Also, we are starting a new drive to develop a pool of regular donors who would become a regular source of finance. Next year, we are going to increase the scale of the initiative by having a section for live performances that will include local Indigenous artists.

SECTION D – Impact

Expected number of attendees	250
Expected number of local creative professionals (e.g. artists, performers)	15
Expected number of community partners with an active role	5
Expected number of sponsors and local businesses with an active role	1
Expected number of volunteers supporting the initiative	13
Expected number of organizations that are part of the event site by default (i.e. brick and mortar businesses that are within the area of the initiative)	1

SECTION E – Full Initiative Budget**Revenues**

Cash Revenue Source (e.g. granting body, sponsor name, etc.)	Description of Cash Revenue (e.g. name of grant, what's being sponsored, etc.)	Status (Pending or Confirmed)	Amount (\$)
City of Calgary	Arts and Culture Microgrant	PENDING	5,000.00
Your Organization	Amount contributed by your organization	CONFIRMED	856.00
		Select	
		Select	
		Select	
		Select	
		Select	
		Select	
		Select	
		Select	
		Select	
		Select	
A. Sub-Total of Cash Revenue			\$ 5,856.00

In-Kind Revenue Source (e.g. sponsor name)	Description of In-Kind Revenue (e.g. what's being sponsored)	Status (Pending or Confirmed)	Amount (\$)
Amenida Residences	Venue rental discount provided for consecutive bookings.	Pending	100.00
Catering Subsidy (Labor)	Community Volunteer Cooks	Confirmed	700.00
		Select	
		Select	
		Select	
		Select	
		Select	
		Select	
B. Sub-Total of In-Kind Revenue			\$ 800.00

Total Revenue	C. Cash Revenue (Box A) + In-Kind Revenue (Box B)	\$ 6,656.00
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Arts and Culture Microgrant 2026 Application

Expenses*

*Include all expenses. Funding will be allocated only to eligible expenses (see guidelines)

[illegible]

Revenue Less Expenses (Total Revenue (Box C) – Total Expenses (Box D))		\$ 0.00
* Must equal \$0 or your budget is out of balance.		

Total Amount of Funding Requested: \$ 5,000.00 (must match amount listed in the budget)

SECTION F – Declaration**Part A – Authority of the Grant Writer**

I certify that I am authorized to act on behalf of the applicant and the company or organization listed in the application. The information contained in this Arts and Culture Microgrant Application is true and correct to the best of my knowledge and will be upheld through City bylaws, policies, and procedures.

Declaration made by: Abdikhadar Hassan Obsiye

Part B – General Terms

I understand that if this application is successful, the applicant will receive a cheque for the amount approved. Accepting the payment means that the applicant agrees to:

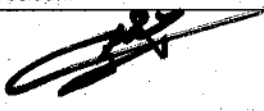
- Acknowledge the City of Calgary as a funder in any related digital or print advertising, promotional materials and public communication,
- Spend the money as indicated in the budget provided in this application,
- **Tier 2 funding requires 100% matching;** any unmatched funding must be returned to the City of Calgary
- Consult with the City of Calgary about any major changes to the initiative that become necessary including date changes, venue changes, significant budget revisions, etc.
- Provide the City of Calgary with a final report no later than 60 days after the initiative end date (as noted on page 3 of this application)

Declaration made by: Abdikhadar Hassan Obsiye

Part C – Participation in Free City of Calgary Promotional Campaigns

Select your preference: Yes, please include our initiative in any free City of Calgary promot

SECTION G - Signature

Name of grant writer	Abdikhadar Hassan Obsiye
Position with the organization	Vice President
Signature of grant writer	
Date signed	Feb. 16, 2026

SECTION H – How to Submit

- Email the completed application and any additional documents to microgrants@calgary.ca
- Use the subject line: "AC26 – [Insert Your Initiative Title]"
- Applications must be submitted before 11:59 p.m. MT on the deadline date
 - Tier 1: 30 days before initiative start date (as noted on page 3 of this application)
 - Tier 2, Intake 1: March 4, 2026
 - Tier 2, Intake 2: September 2, 2026

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